famous) and many comets, and smaller, rocky bodies called asteroids and meteoroids (Figure 2.4). Earth is the third planet from the Sun. Saturn, with its gorgeous rings, is the sixth planet out and plays a role in *Interstellar* (Chapter 15).

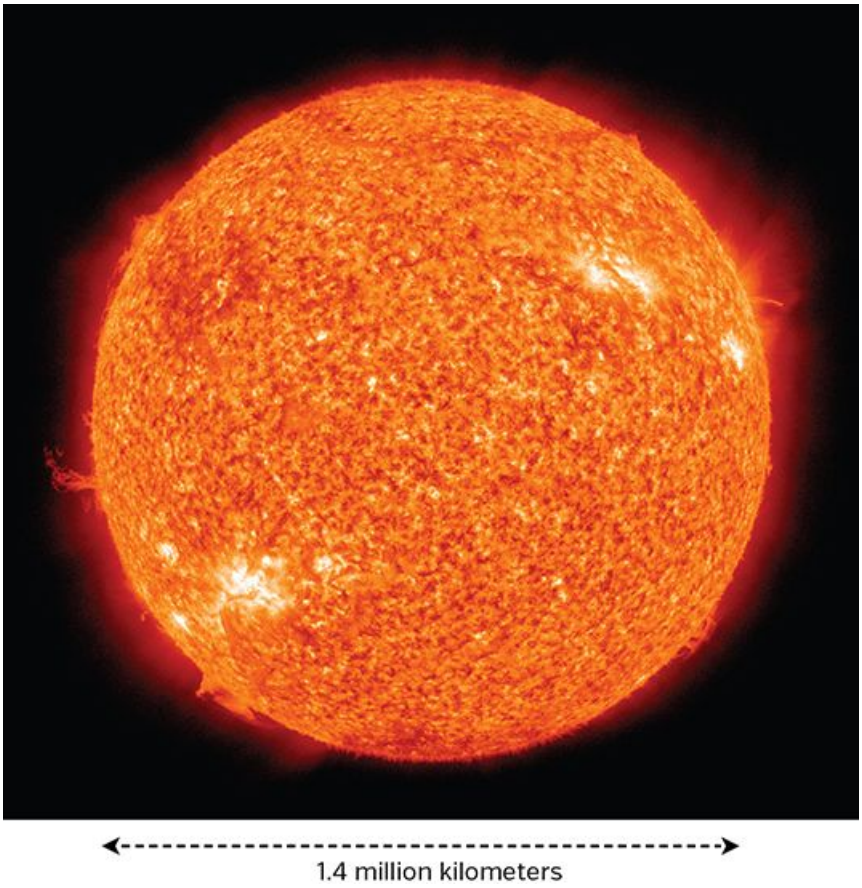


Fig 2.3. The Sun as photographed by NASA's Solar Dynamics Observatory.